should be prosecuted for treason. To his supporters, Snowden was an idealist risking his future and safety to bring light to a hidden government out of control. An editorial in the *New York Times* stated, "The shrill brigade of his critics say Mr. Snowden has done profound damage to intelligence operations of the United States, but none has presented the slightest proof that his disclosures really hurt the nation's security. . . . he has done his country a great service."[3]

Was he a villain or a hero, a traitor or a patriot? Snowden was reluctant to talk about his past, instead wanting to keep the focus on the documents themselves. But a portrait slowly emerged of a computer genius who never finished high school or earned a college degree—a young man who happily followed in his family's footsteps by working in the federal government. His tech expertise helped him land jobs in government security, where he gained access to secret documents. Snowden made a series of discoveries that led him to believe the government was abusing the people it is meant to protect. Disillusioned with his country's deep reach into citizens' private lives, Snowden was faced with a decision—a decision that would change his life and, quite possibly, change the world.

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